

UNIT 1: The Gift of the Magi

O Henry

Essay

Introduction

"The Gift of the Magi" is a short story by O. Henry. The story was first published in *The New York Sunday World* in 1905, and it was later included in Henry's 1906 short story collection, *The Four Million*. It has since become one of Henry's best-known and most frequently adapted works.

Set in New York City, "The Gift of the Magi" details young, impoverished Della Dillingham Young's quest to buy the perfect Christmas gift for her husband, Jim.

Plot Summary

Della Dillingham Young has one dollar and eighty-seven cents with which to buy her beloved husband, Jim, a Christmas gift. She is dismayed at how meager the amount is, as she has spent months saving. The Dillingham Youngs are very poor, with Jim's earnings having been reduced from thirty dollars a week to only twenty dollars. She reflects that she has spent many hours fantasizing about buying Jim a nice gift, one that would show him how pleased she is to be his wife. However, with only one dollar and eighty-seven cents, she knows she will be unable to acquire a suitable present.

Inspiration strikes when Della catches sight of herself in the mirror. She pulls her hair down and lets the long tresses settle around her. The Dillingham Youngs have two prized possessions: Della's beautiful hair and Jim's gold watch, which he received from his father. Della quickly ties her hair up again and, after shedding a few tears, leaves the apartment.

Della walks to Mme. Sofronie's Hair Goods store with a "brilliant sparkle" in her eyes. She asks if Madame Sofronie will buy her hair, to which the Madame replies that she will need to see it first. Della lets down her hair, and Madame Sofronie offers her twenty dollars for it. Requesting only that the Madame make the process "quick," Della agrees to sell her hair. She spends the next two hours searching for the perfect gift for Jim and finally

decides upon a simple but tasteful platinum watch chain. She remarks that the watch chain suits Jim perfectly, as it is understated but undeniably valuable. Once the chain is attached to Jim's watch, he will be able to proudly show off his prized possession without being ashamed of the battered leather strap he currently uses in place of a chain.

When Della gets home, she tries to style her new haircut as best she can. She worries that Jim will be angry and will no longer think she is pretty. When Jim sees Della has cut her hair, he gets a strange look on his face. Not knowing what it means, Della goes to him and quickly explains that she sold her hair to buy him a Christmas present. In response, Jim hugs her and tells her he loves her no matter what her hair looks like. He then gives her a Christmas present: a set of jeweled tortoiseshell combs she'd once admired in a shop window. Della loves the present, but she bursts into tears when she realizes she is unable to use Jim's thoughtful gift. As Jim comforts her, she reassures him her hair will grow back quickly. She then excitedly gives him the platinum watch chain. Jim laughs and reveals he sold his prized watch to pay for the combs. The narrator concludes the story by praising the couple for their selfless gifts of love, calling them even wiser than the three wise magi who brought gifts to the baby Jesus on the first Christmas Eve.

GRAMMAR

SYNONYMS AND ANTONYMS

UNIT 2: The Brook

Alfred Lord Tennyson

Essay

Introduction

This poem "The Brook" is written by Alfred Lord Tennyson. The poet speaks in the voice of a brook, or a small stream, and tells us about the journey it goes through to finally merge with the river. The poem is divided into twelve stanzas.

The Thought

The poet assumes the voice of the brook. The brook says that it comes from the haunts of coot and hern, water birds. It rushes forward suddenly. Its water sparkles under the sunlight as it flows among ferns. Then the brook flows down a valley.

In the second stanza, he says that the brook runs down thirty hills, or slips into the gaps between the hills. It flows by twenty villages, a little town, and half a hundred bridges.

At last, it flows by Philip's farm to join the brimming river. The brook finally joins the river after flowing past the farm of a man named Philip. It insists that men may come and men may go, but it goes on forever. This means that although humans live short lives that are constantly changing, the brook will last forever.

In the stanza 4, the poet says that the brook flows over stony ways creating musical notes such as little sharps and trebles. It bubbles into swirling seas and makes a murmuring sound on the pebbles.

It curves many times along its banks, and passes by many a field and fallow, a deserted farmland. It also passes by places that are so beautiful and enchanting that they seem to be inhabited by fairies. These lands are filled with plants such as willow-weed and mallow.

The brook makes noises that seem like chatter as it flows to join the brimming river. It again repeats that men may come and men may go, but it goes on forever.

The brook winds about, or zigzags in and out of many places. It sometimes finds a flower blossom sailing along its surface. It also finds fish such as trout and graylings in its waters.

Sometimes, the brook foams up as it flows. It travels with many a silvery water break above the golden gravel. This means that the surface of the brook breaks out in silvery waves that crash against the sand and pebbles below it.

The brook draws all these things along and flows to join the brimming river. The brook once again says that men may come and men may go, but it goes on for ever.

The brook slips, slides, glooms and glances. The word "gloom" represents how the brook might turn dark and murky at times. The other words represent its playful nature. It is accompanied by skimming swallows. Birds known as swallows brush the surface of the brook as they search for food. The brook makes netted sunbeams that dance against its sandy shallows. When sunlight passes through the surface of water, it forms a netted shadow on the sand below the water. This shadow keeps moving because of the flowing water, making it look like the sunlight is dancing.

The brook passes quietly in the night time under moon and stars as it flows past forests filled with shrubs. It slows down to linger by its shingly bars, or banks filled with little pebbles. It takes its time to loiter round the plants that grow along its banks, such as cresses.

It then curves out and flows to join the brimming river. It ends by again stating that men may come and men may go, but the brook goes on forever.

Conclusion

This poem narrates the journey of a brook. It flows over hills and by villages, seeing various sights on its way, to ultimately join the river. The brook's journey shows us the beauty and power of nature. It also makes us aware of human mortality and nature's eternity.

GRAMMAR

PARAGRAPH WRITING

PREPOSITIONS

UNIT 3: Elon Musk

OUTLINE OF THE BIOGRAPHY

Introduction

- **Early Years**
- **Zip2**
- **X.Com And Paypal**
- **Space X**
- **Tesla**
- **The Boring Company And Hyperloop**
- **Neuralink And Neural Interface Technology**
- **Conclusion**

GRAMMAR

CORRECT FORM OF THE VERBS GIVEN IN THE BRACKETS

ARTICLES

Unit 4: The Toys of Peace

Saki

FULL STORY

"Harvey," said Eleanor Bope, handing her brother a cutting from a London morning paper of the 19th of March, "just read this about children's toys, please; it exactly carries out some of our ideas about influence and upbringing."

"In the view of the National Peace Council," ran the extract, "there are grave objections to presenting our boys with regiments of fighting men, batteries of guns, and squadrons of 'Dreadnoughts.' Boys, the Council admits, naturally love fighting and all the panoply of war . . . but that is no reason for encouraging, and perhaps giving permanent form to, their primitive instincts. At the Children's Welfare Exhibition, which opens at Olympia in three weeks' time, the Peace Council will make an alternative suggestion to parents in the shape of an exhibition of 'peace toys.' In front of a specially-painted representation of the Peace Palace at The Hague will be grouped, not miniature soldiers but miniature civilians, not guns but ploughs and the tools of industry . . . It is hoped that manufacturers may take a hint from the exhibit, which will bear fruit in the toy shops."

"The idea is certainly an interesting and very well-meaning one," said Harvey; "whether it would succeed well in practice --"

"We must try," interrupted his sister; "you are coming down to us at Easter, and you always bring the boys some toys, so that will be an excellent opportunity for you to inaugurate the new experiment. Go about in the shops and buy any little toys and models that have special bearing on civilian life in its more peaceful aspects. Of course you must explain the toys to the children and interest them in the new idea. I regret to say that the 'Siege of Adrianople' toy, that their Aunt Susan sent them, didn't need any explanation; they knew all the uniforms and flags, and even the names of the respective commanders, and when I heard them one day using what

seemed to be the most objectionable language they said it was Bulgarian words of command; of course it may have been, but at any rate I took the toy away from them. Now I shall expect your Easter gifts to give quite a new impulse and direction to the children's minds; Eric is not eleven yet, and Bertie is only nine-and-a-half, so they are really at a most impressionable age."

"There is primitive instinct to be taken into consideration, you know," said Henry doubtfully, "and hereditary tendencies as well. One of their great-uncles fought in the most intolerant fashion at Inkerman -- he was specially mentioned in dispatches, I believe -- and their great-grandfather smashed all his Whig neighbours' hot houses when the great Reform Bill was passed. Still, as you say, they are at an impressionable age. I will do my best."

On Easter Saturday Harvey Bope unpacked a large, promising-looking red cardboard box under the expectant eyes of his nephews. "Your uncle has brought you the newest thing in toys," Eleanor had said impressively, and youthful anticipation had been anxiously divided between Albanian soldiery and a Somali camel-corps. Eric was hotly in favour of the latter contingency. "There would be Arabs on horseback," he whispered; "the Albanians have got jolly uniforms, and they fight all day long, and all night, too, when there's a moon, but the country's rocky, so they've got no cavalry."

A quantity of crinkly paper shavings was the first thing that met the view when the lid was removed; the most exiting toys always began like that. Harvey pushed back the top layer and drew forth a square, rather featureless building.

"It's a fort!" exclaimed Bertie.

"It isn't, it's the palace of the Mpret of Albania," said Eric, immensely proud of his knowledge of the exotic title; "it's got no windows, you see, so that passers-by can't fire in at the Royal Family."

"It's a municipal dust-bin," said Harvey hurriedly; "you see all the refuse and litter of a town is collected there, instead of lying about and injuring the health of the citizens."

In an awful silence he disinterred a little lead figure of a man in black clothes.

"That," he said, "is a distinguished civilian, John Stuart Mill. He was an authority on political economy."

"Why?" asked Bertie.

"Well, he wanted to be; he thought it was a useful thing to be."

Bertie gave an expressive grunt, which conveyed his opinion that there was no accounting for tastes.

Another square building came out, this time with windows and chimneys.

"A model of the Manchester branch of the Young Women's Christian Association," said Harvey.

"Are there any lions?" asked Eric hopefully. He had been reading Roman history and thought that where you found Christians you might reasonably expect to find a few lions.

"There are no lions," said Harvey. "Here is another civilian, Robert Raikes, the founder of Sunday schools, and here is a model of a municipal wash-house. These little round things are loaves baked in a sanitary

bakehouse. That lead figure is a sanitary inspector, this one is a district councillor, and this one is an official of the Local Government Board."

"What does he do?" asked Eric wearily.

"He sees to things connected with his Department," said Harvey. "This box with a slit in it is a ballot-box. Votes are put into it at election times."

"What is put into it at other times?" asked Bertie.

"Nothing. And here are some tools of industry, a wheelbarrow and a hoe, and I think these are meant for hop-poles. This is a model beehive, and that is a ventilator, for ventilating sewers. This seems to be another municipal dust-bin -- no, it is a model of a school of art and public library. This little lead figure is Mrs. Hemans, a poetess, and this is Rowland Hill, who introduced the system of penny postage. This is Sir John Herschel, the eminent astrologer."

"Are we to play with these civilian figures?" asked Eric.

"Of course," said Harvey, "these are toys; they are meant to be played with."

"But how?"

It was rather a poser. "You might make two of them contest a seat in Parliament," said Harvey, "and have an election --"

"With rotten eggs, and free fights, and ever so many broken heads!" exclaimed Eric.

"And noses all bleeding and everybody drunk as can be," echoed Bertie, who had carefully studied one of Hogarth's pictures.

"Nothing of the kind," said Harvey, "nothing in the least like that. Votes will be put in the ballot-box, and the Mayor will count them -- and he will say which has received the most votes, and then the two candidates will thank him for presiding, and each will say that the contest has been conducted throughout in the pleasantest and most straightforward fashion, and they part with expressions of mutual esteem. There's a jolly game for you boys to play. I never had such toys when I was young."

"I don't think we'll play with them just now," said Eric, with an entire absence of the enthusiasm that his uncle had shown; "I think perhaps we ought to do a little of our holiday task. It's history this time; we've got to learn up something about the Bourbon period in France."

"The Bourbon period," said Harvey, with some disapproval in his voice.

"We've got to know something about Louis the Fourteenth," continued Eric; "I've learnt the names of all the principal battles already."

This would never do. "There were, of course, some battles fought during his reign," said Harvey, "but I fancy the accounts of them were much exaggerated; news was very unreliable in those days, and there were practically no war correspondents, so generals and commanders could magnify every little skirmish they engaged in till they reached the proportions of decisive battles. Louis was really famous, now, as a landscape gardener; the way he laid out Versailles was so much admired that it was copied all over Europe."

"Do you know anything about Madame Du Barry?" asked Eric; "didn't she have her head chopped off?"

"She was another great lover of gardening," said Harvey, evasively; "in fact, I believe the well known rose Du Barry was named after her, and now I think you had better play for a little and leave your lessons till later."

Harvey retreated to the library and spent some thirty or forty minutes in wondering whether it would be possible to compile a history, for use in elementary schools, in which there should be no prominent mention of battles, massacres, murderous intrigues, and violent deaths. The York and Lancaster period and the Napoleonic era would, he admitted to himself, present considerable difficulties, and the Thirty Years' War would entail something of a gap if you left it out altogether. Still, it would be something gained if, at a highly impressionable age, children could be got to fix their attention on the invention of calico printing instead of the Spanish Armada or the Battle of Waterloo.

It was time, he thought, to go back to the boys' room, and see how they were getting on with their peace toys. As he stood outside the door he could hear Eric's voice raised in command; Bertie chimed in now and again with a helpful suggestion.

"That is Louis the Fourteenth," Eric was saying, "that one in kneebreeches, that Uncle said invented Sunday schools. It isn't a bit like him, but it'll have to do."

"We'll give him a purple coat from my paintbox by and by," said Bertie.

"Yes, an' red heels. That is Madame de Maintenon, that one he called Mrs. Hemans. She begs Louis not to go on this expedition, but he turns a deaf ear. He takes Marshal Saxe with him, and we must pretend that they have thousands of men with them. The watchword is Qui vive? and the answer is L'etat c'est moi -- that was one of his favourite remarks, you know. They land at Manchester in the dead of the night, and a Jacobite conspirator gives them the keys of the fortress."

Peeping in through the doorway Harvey observed that the municipal dustbin had been pierced with holes to accommodate the muzzles of imaginary cannon, and now represented the principal fortified position in Manchester; John Stuart Mill had been dipped in red ink, and apparently stood for Marshal Saxe.

"Louis orders his troops to surround the Young Women's Christian Association and seize the lot of them. 'Once back at the Louvre and the girls are mine,' he exclaims. We must use Mrs. Hemans again for one of the girls; she says 'Never,' and stabs Marshal Saxe to the heart."

"He bleeds dreadfully," exclaimed Bertie, splashing red ink liberally over the facade of the Association building.

"The soldiers rush in and avenge his death with the utmost savagery. A hundred girls are killed" -- here Bertie emptied the remainder of the red ink over the devoted building -- "and the surviving five hundred are dragged off to the French ships. 'I have lost a Marshal,' says Louis, 'but I do not go back empty-handed.'"

Harvey stole away from the room, and sought out his sister.

"Eleanor," he said, "the experiment --"

"Yes?"

"Has failed. We have begun too late."

GRAMMAR

OFFICIAL LETTERS AND EMAIL WRITING

UNIT 5

THE POWER OF INTRAPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

AN OUTLINE

Introduction:

Intrapersonal communication and self-conceptualisation

- Self-esteem:
- Self-image:
- Self-efficacy

Emotional regulation and Intrapersonal Communication

- Emotional awareness
- Emotional regulation
- Emotional expression

Intrapersonal Communication and decision-making

- Critical thinking
- Value alignment
- Goal setting

Intrapersonal Communication and personal growth

- Positive self talk
- Coping strategies
- Adaptive thinking

Intrapersonal Communication and well-being

- Reducing negative self-talk
- Enhancing self-compassion
- Boosting confidence

Cultivating effective Intrapersonal Communication

- Mindfulness
- Journaling
- Meditation
- Positive affirmation
- Seeking feedback
- Conclusion

GRAMMAR

CORRECTION OF SENTENCES

COMPREHENSION PASSAGE